

Sales Training — Session 43

Process Your Problems.

Don't Hide Them.

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WHAT THIS SESSION IS The mistake most reps make when personal life gets hard: they try to hide it, suppress it, or push through it as though it wasn't happening. This session offers the opposite discipline — how to **PROCESS** problems rather than bury them, why gratitude is the tool that produces the shift, and why processed emotion produces calmer, more present sales calls than emotion pretended-away ever will.

1. The question every rep eventually asks

How do you stop problems in your personal life from affecting your work? Every rep asks a version of this eventually — usually during a stretch when something outside the office is genuinely hard, and they can feel it leaking into their calls. The instinct is to look for a technique. Compartmentalisation. Suppression. Willpower. A way to switch the emotion off at the office door and switch it back on at 5pm.

The session's answer is that the technique doesn't exist. You don't stop your emotions from affecting your work. You're a person, not a machine, and the attempt to become one produces worse outcomes than the honest alternative. What you **CAN** do is learn to process the emotions in a healthy way — so they don't ambush you mid-call, and so you don't carry accumulated weight into every future decision.

"You don't hide it. You don't pretend it isn't there. You learn to process it — because that's the only way to keep moving forward without carrying it into every conversation."

2. Everyone has something. Some of it is life-changing.

A grounding observation. Every person in the room, at any given moment, is dealing with something. Some of it is small and background. Some of it is significant. Some of it will arrive without warning and change the shape of a life in an afternoon. There's no version of a career — or of adult life — where problems stop appearing. The question isn't how to avoid them. The question is how to keep functioning while they're happening.

This is worth stating explicitly because most people carry a quiet belief that other people don't have their level of chaos — that the polished colleague across the room has it all sorted and the rep having a hard week is uniquely broken. It isn't true. The polished colleague is processing something. Everyone is. Recognising that unclogs the rep's shame about their own difficulty and frees them to work on the actual skill — processing — rather than trying to look like a person who never needs to.

3. Gratitude — not the greeting-card kind

The primary tool the session offered. But the word "gratitude" carries a lot of soft, hollow associations — the kind of thing on inspirational mugs. The gratitude the session means is different. It's the discipline of finding something real to appreciate **INSIDE** a genuinely difficult situation. Not pretending the situation isn't difficult. Not manufacturing false positivity. Just refusing to let the hardest part of a moment define the whole of it.

This matters because perspective is the mechanism. A rep who can locate one true thing to be grateful for during a bad week has anchored themselves to something outside the pain. That anchor point doesn't reduce the pain — it just prevents the pain from becoming the entire field of view. The rep can still function. The rep can still show up. The rep can still call the next buyer without carrying the whole weight of the week into the opening sentence.

"Gratitude isn't pretending everything is wonderful. It's refusing to let one difficult moment define your entire outlook. That's what changes."

4. Corie's story — the day his father died

The session's anchor example. The day Corie's father passed away unexpectedly was one of the hardest of his life. Nothing about it was easy. Nothing about it was fair. In the immediate aftermath there was nothing to be grateful for — the loss was the loss.

Someone later offered him a different frame. Instead of a stranger delivering the news to his mother — a phone call from an unknown number changing the shape of her afternoon — Corie was there himself. He was the one to sit with her during one of the hardest days of her life. The situation hadn't changed. The father was still gone. But there was one thing inside the moment that, honestly, was something to be grateful for. That single point of anchor didn't erase the pain. It gave the pain meaning. And meaning is what makes hard things survivable.

"The situation hadn't changed. But the perspective had. Gratitude doesn't erase pain — it helps you find meaning inside it."

5. The three questions to ask on a hard day

A simpler tool for the daily version of the discipline. When a stretch feels genuinely difficult, the session offered a short mental check. Three questions:

- Can you eat?
- Can you breathe?
- Can you live another day?

If the answer to all three is yes — and it almost always is — then the rep still has opportunity, choice, and time. This isn't meant to minimise the problem. The problem is real. But the check makes the ground under the rep visible. There's still a path forward. There's still a next call. There's still a tomorrow. The heaviness of the moment doesn't remove any of those. Being reminded of them is often enough to loosen the grip of a bad afternoon.

6. The two questions inside every setback

A directional discipline. Every challenge the rep meets can be processed with one of two questions. The first — "why is this happening to me?" — produces frustration, self-pity, and a felt sense of unfairness. The second — "what can I learn from this?" — produces movement, curiosity, and an eventual skill gain. Neither question makes the setback easier. They just point the rep in different directions after.

This isn't automatic. Most people default to the first question when a setback lands, because it's the natural emotional response. The discipline is to notice the default and swap it, deliberately. "Why is this happening?" runs its course, and the rep gently redirects to "what's the lesson here?" Over time the redirect becomes faster. Eventually it becomes automatic. The strongest reps aren't the ones who never feel the first question — they're the ones who don't linger there for long.

"One question creates frustration. The other creates progress. The strongest people aren't the ones who never have setbacks — they're the ones who look for the lesson inside them."

7. Processing isn't a solo activity

A correction to the loner-genius myth. There's a common belief that the strongest people process everything alone — that reaching out is weakness. It isn't. The strongest people know when to ask, and who to ask. Sometimes the whole processing move is just speaking a thought out loud to a trusted person. The thought stops looping inside the rep's head the moment it's said aloud to another human. Someone else's perspective adds context the rep couldn't generate alone. Sometimes just knowing another person heard it is enough to reduce the weight.

Reps should have a small circle they can process with — a partner, a close friend, a colleague, a mentor. Not to unload on. To think alongside. The goal isn't sympathy; it's clarity. And clarity almost always requires a second brain in the room to produce.

"Strong people aren't the ones who never need help. They're the ones who know when to ask for it. Talk to someone. Ask for perspective. That's not weakness — that's process."

8. Customers can feel your mindset

Why this session sits inside a sales training rather than a wellness one. Every buyer the rep speaks to is doing pattern recognition on the rep's tone. Overwhelmed, negative, distracted reps get treated differently than calm, present ones — even by buyers who couldn't articulate what they're picking up on. The felt mindset of the rep is a variable in every call, and reps who don't process what they're carrying end up leaking it into every conversation.

Processed reps sound different. Calmer. More present. Less reactive. They can be told "no" without spiralling. They can hear an objection as information rather than as a personal

attack. They can hold a silence in a call without rushing to fill it. Those tonal qualities aren't a technique — they're a byproduct of a rep who has already dealt with their own weight before picking up the phone.

9. Respond, don't react

A small distinction with a large effect. Reactive selling is what an unprocessed rep does — the buyer's words trigger the rep's emotions, and the rep's next line is a defensive or anxious response to that trigger. Responsive selling is what a processed rep does — the buyer's words are received, considered, and responded to with intent. The buyer feels both, and they respond very differently to each.

A reactive rep is easy to destabilise. A challenging buyer question, a firm objection, a mildly rude comment — any of these can put a reactive rep on the back foot for the rest of the call. A responsive rep is much harder to move. The buyer can push and the rep just receives it, considers it, and responds. That stability is a competitive advantage buyers can feel. It reads as competence — because it is.

10. Life will always give you problems

The session closed on the honest frame. Life is not going to stop giving reps problems. That isn't a design flaw — it's a feature of being alive. What separates the reps who last from the reps who don't isn't the absence of hard things. It's what they do with them. Reps who process build resilience over time. Reps who suppress accumulate weight that eventually catches up with them, usually in ways that look — from the outside — like sudden burnout or unexplained career departure.

"The goal isn't to hide your problems. The goal is to develop the mindset to move forward despite them. Every difficult experience is a chance to become stronger than you were before."

11. Action items for the team

1. When something outside work is hitting hard, name it internally — don't pretend it isn't happening. The naming is the first step of processing.
2. On any bad day, run the three-question check: can you eat, can you breathe, can you live another day? If yes, the ground under you is still there.
3. When a setback lands and you notice "why is this happening to me?" running — let it pass, then deliberately swap to "what can I learn from this?"
4. Identify one specific person in your life you can process with. Not to complain to. To think alongside. Use them when the loop gets stuck.
5. Find one true thing to be grateful for during a hard week. Not manufactured positivity. One real anchor point that widens the field of view.

6. Before picking up the phone for the first call of the day, run a 30-second internal check on what you're carrying. Process it before you dial.
7. When a buyer says something that would normally trigger a reaction, pause for a beat. Receive. Respond. Don't react.

THE RULE OF THUMB You don't hide problems — you process them. Real gratitude finds one true anchor inside a hard moment. "What can I learn from this?" beats "why is this happening to me?" every time. Processed reps sound calmer, present better, and close more — not because they've suppressed the emotion, but because they've already dealt with it before the call starts.